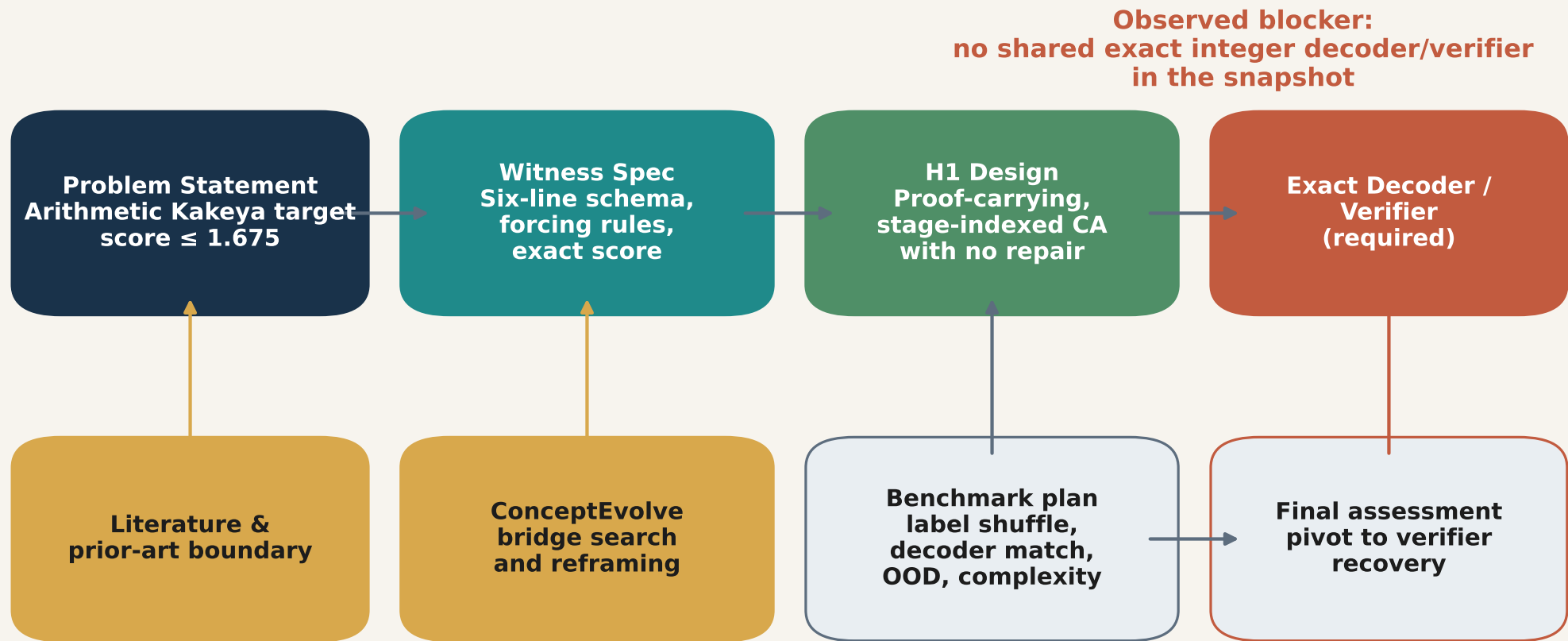




All empirical claims route through the exact decoder/verifier box. Its absence propagates a deliberate block to phase-4 evaluation, preserving negative results instead of substituting proxy metrics.